

COVER STORY: MAYAWATI

CAN SHE RULE INDIA?

22

The second most important woman of Indian politics is all set to rock the established hierarchy of power as the ambitious leader of a formidable coalition. India suddenly gets another prime minister in waiting.



BANDEEP SINGH

NATION: CASH FOR VOTES

Sting is King

34

In the season of sting operations, all it takes is a CD for every political party to claim its own version of the truth. However, the grainy images and double roles by several players show that while much has been uncovered the truth is still elusive.

STATES: JAMMU AND KASHMIR



AP

Downward Spiral

37

The UPA's flip-flops on the Amarnath land transfer backfire as Hindus resort to continued violence paralysing the state's economy and turning a local issue into a national concern.

NEIGHBOURS: SAARC SUMMIT

Reading the Riot Act

44

Following the suicide attack at its Kabul mission and the violation of ceasefire, India turns the heat on Pakistan as the two premiers meet on the sidelines of the summit.



AP



BEIJING 2008: CURTAIN RAISER

Beijing Big Bang

54



REUTERS

As the Chinese capital gets ready for the 29th Olympic Games, they are calling it 'Beijingism', the collective will of 1.3 billion people to top the gold medal table ahead of their arch rival, the United States.

INVESTIGATION: PHILATELY

Stamp of a Scam

46

Commemorative stamps find their way to collectors even before they are officially released. Dealers charge a hefty premium, but it is a small price to pay for exclusivity, even as it is illegal.

OFFTRACK.....	11
INDIASCOPE.....	12
BUSINESS AND ECONOMY.....	40
SOCIETY AND THE ARTS.....	68
YOUR WEEK.....	75
EYECATCHERS.....	82

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